



Professional Development, MBI F601

1 Credit
Fall, 2023

Land Acknowledgement

- The University of Alaska Fairbanks' (UAF) Troth Yeddha' campus in Fairbanks, Alaska is located on the unceded, traditional homelands of the Lower Tanana Dene.
- UAF's College of Fisheries and Ocean Sciences campus in Juneau, Alaska is located on the unceded territories of the Áak'w Kwáan.
- A map of Indigenous Peoples and Languages of Alaska can be found [here](#).

COVID-19 statement

Students should keep up-to-date on the university's policies, practices, and mandates related to COVID-19 by regularly checking [this website](#). Students are expected to adhere to the university's policies, practices, and mandates related to public health. While the formal COVID-19 response has ended, the advice that was true throughout the pandemic remains true now - please stay home if you are sick, cover your cough, and wash your hands to help keep our university communities healthy.

General Information

<i>Instructor:</i>	Kristen Gorman	<i>Office Location:</i>	Irving II, room 231
<i>Email:</i>	kggorman@alaska.edu	<i>Office Hours:</i>	Wednesdays 1 – 2 pm
<i>Telephone:</i>	907-474-5930	<i>*Course Type:</i>	Lecture: In-person, Online, Synchronous
<i>**Course Location:</i>	In-person: Irving I, room 201 Online: https://alaska.zoom.us/join/register/tZEkcOGqqzpkGNMzPd1MkBTiH6UqMaQfnbAK <u>Canvas</u> is our Learning Management System.	<i>Meeting Time:</i>	Wednesdays 11:45 am - 12:45 pm (August 30 – December 6, 2023) Final: 10:15 am – 12:15 pm on Friday, December 15, 2023

Additional General Information

- As this course's instructor, I respectfully acknowledge Alaska's First Peoples and their long history of living in deep connection with their land and water, and the historical and ongoing legacy of colonialism. As a life-long student, I am committed to learning about injustice, and working to improve equity in my professional and personal life.
- This course meets in-person and online via Zoom during lecture hours (i.e., synchronously, see details above). **All students** (i.e., in-person or online attendees) **must register in advance** for the Zoom meeting to allow for the possibility of meeting entirely remotely due to unforeseen circumstances. After registering, you will receive a confirmation email containing information about joining the meeting, **you can save this information to your Google calendar to easily find the Zoom link each week.**



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- Our in-class sessions will be recorded via Zoom to provide flexibility to those students who cannot attend. These recordings will be posted on Canvas (see weekly Modules), and therefore only available to enrolled students in this class. Despite classes being recorded, **students who will miss class should notify the instructor in advance** (see details below).
- If you need assistance navigating Zoom or Canvas please contact your instructor or [UAF's eCampus Student Support](#).

Prerequisites

None. Graduate student status recommended.

Course description

Improve ability to make oral and poster presentations and to write resumes and cover letters. Includes lectures, discussions, and four individual projects. Students are encouraged to use their thesis/dissertation material for the posters and oral presentations. Feedback on all projects will be given by both instructor and students.

In-depth Course description

This course will improve students' professional communication skills in conference presentations (oral and poster), elevator talks (a short, professional introduction on your work), and their Curriculum Vitae (CV). Other topics include writing professional job cover letters, as well as other potential topics of interest identified by the students. The course will include lectures, discussions, and individual projects. Students are strongly encouraged to use their thesis/dissertation material for the posters and oral presentations. Feedback on all presentations/projects will be given by both the instructor and the students. Grades will be assigned by the instructor. The course is designed to be a collaborative learning opportunity to practice and gain feedback on skills important to being a professional in the natural sciences.

Representative Course Readings/Materials

All reading materials will be provided to students. There is no required textbook.

Technology Requirements

The course requires regular access to a computer and the internet to view and download any online materials in [Canvas](#). At various points during the semester, you will need to download course material and upload completed assignments. For the purposes of this course, **please use your @alaska.edu email account only for correspondence with the instructor**, or the Canvas inbox feature to ensure that you do not miss any important information from the instructor (or other university departments).

Course Goals

A primary goal of the course is to provide students an opportunity to practice and gain feedback on skills important to being a professional in the natural sciences. Specifically, communicating your science to broad audiences, communicating your skills and abilities to future employers, and explore strategies for being a productive scientist and excellent collaborator.

Student Learning Outcomes

It is expected that this course will help students improve their ability to develop and deliver oral and poster presentations, communicate their research, and to write CVs and cover letters. The course will also explore best practices for professional productivity and collaboration.



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Instructional Methods

The course is lecture- and discussion-based. Students are expected to attend class during regular meeting times, review reading materials as communicated by the instructor, and contribute to class discussions. Students who must attend remotely will be able to do so via Zoom link during meeting times. Lecture slides will be made

available after class and lectures will be recorded for students with excused absences or those attending asynchronously.

Explanation of Student Effort

Students are expected to attend 1 hour of lecture/discussion each week, and spend another 2-3 hours each week reading, or preparing assignments and presentations. In general, students should expect to spend about 3 hours each week on this course.

Tentative Course Calendar

Week	Date	Topic	Delivery
1	Wed, Aug 30	Welcome, course orientation, schedule, discussion of topics	Synchronous
2	Wed, Sept 6	Oral Presentations Module	Synchronous
3	Wed, Sept 13	No class (Gorman in field). Watch videos on oral and poster presentations.	Asynchronous
4	Wed, Sept 20	Poster Presentations Module	Synchronous
5	Wed, Sept 27	Student Oral Presentations PROJECT 1	Synchronous
6	Wed, Oct 4	Discussion on Oral Presentations Project 1	Synchronous
7	Wed, Oct 11	Student Poster Presentations PROJECT2	Synchronous
8	Wed, Oct 18	Discussion on Poster Presentations Project 2	Synchronous
9	Wed, Oct 25	Elevator Talk Module (Intro and Research)	Synchronous
9	Fri, Oct 27	<i>Submit final video of Oral and Poster Presentations (on Canvas) for grades. Due by 5 pm.</i>	-----
10	Wed, Nov 1	Student Elevator Talk PROJECT 3	Synchronous
11	Wed, Nov 8	Discussion on Elevator Talk Project 3	Synchronous
12	Wed, Nov 15	CV (short and long CVs) and Cover Letter Module	Synchronous
12	Fri, Nov 17	<i>Submit final video of Intro and Research Elevator Talks (on Canvas) for grades. Due by 5 pm.</i>	-----
13	Wed, Nov 22	Student CV and Cover Letter PROJECT 4	Synchronous



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14	Wed, Nov 29	Discussion on CVs and Cover Letters Project 4	Synchronous
15	Wed, Dec 6	Strategies for Productivity and Collaboration Module; Other Topics of Interest	Synchronous
16	Fri, Dec 15 (10:15 am – 12:15 pm)	<i>Submit final CV and Cover Letter (on Canvas) for grades. Due by 12:15 pm. There is no in-class final exam.</i>	----

Evaluation

All projects and participation will be graded following:

Oral Presentation: 20 points, 20%

Poster Presentation: 20 points, 20%

Introduction Elevator Talk: 10 points, 10%

Research Elevator Talk: 10 points, 10%

Short CV: 10 points, 10%

Long CV: 10 points, 10%

Cover Letter: 10 points, 10%

Participation in Discussions: 10 points, 10%

Total Possible Points: 100, 100%

The number of earned total points will be used to determine final grades, which will be on the +/- scale following:

	A = 93-100%	A- = 90-92%
B+ = 87-89%	B = 83-86%	B- = 80-82%
C+ = 77-79%	C = 73-76%	C- = 70-72%
D+ = 67-69%	D = 63-66%	D- = 60-62%
	F = lower than 60%	

Course Policies

1.) Expectations On Progress In Coursework

- All assignments must be submitted on time. Late assignments will be marked down 5% for each day late.
- Please make sure you use your current @alaska.edu email address for all course correspondence. Check your e-mail messages regularly. Class information and changes to the syllabus will be distributed through Canvas to your email. Please note that the course schedule is "tentative", and the "actual" course schedule will be a living document that evolves over the semester (see Canvas).
- This course will require students to have access to the internet, a personal computer, and familiarity with basic computer software programs such as Word, PowerPoint, and Excel.

2.) Attendance, Tardiness, Class Participation, Make-up Exams

- Attendance is required for the course, either in-person or via Zoom, during the course meeting times. Students can miss one class unexcused, but reviewing the material covered during the missed class is your responsibility.



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- Students are expected to participate in all aspects of the course including during lectures by asking questions, and during peer-to-peer discussion session. Please come to class ready to engage with the course material, your fellow classmates, and the instructor. Students will be graded on their participation in discussion for a total of 10% of their final grade.
- Regular attendance, consistent participation, and timely submission of assignments are important for building professional skills and abilities, this course seeks to develop and reinforce such etiquette.
- There are no exams in this course, thus make-up exams are not necessary.

3.) Plagiarism & Academic Integrity

Academic dishonesty applies to examinations, assignments, laboratory reports, fieldwork, practicums, creative projects, or other academic activities. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- a) presenting as their own the ideas or works of others without proper citation of sources;
- b) utilizing devices not authorized by the faculty member;
- c) using sources (including but not limited to text, images, computer code, and audio/video files) not authorized by the faculty member;
- d) providing assistance without the faculty member's permission to another student, or receiving assistance not authorized by the faculty member from anyone (with or without their knowledge);
- e) submitting work done for academic credit in previous classes, without the knowledge and advance permission of the current faculty member;
- f) acting as a substitute or utilizing a substitute;
- g) deceiving faculty members or other representatives of the university to affect a grade or to gain admission to a program or course;
- h) fabricating or misrepresenting data;
- i) possessing, buying, selling, obtaining, or using a copy of any material intended to be used as an instrument of assessment in advance of its administration;
- j) altering grade records of their own or another student's work;
- k) offering a monetary payment or other remuneration in exchange for a grade; or
- l) violating the ethical guidelines or professional standards of a given program.

For more, see [Students Rights and Responsibilities](#).

4.) Classroom Etiquette and Student Behavior Guidelines.

- As with all members of the UAF community, the university requires all in-person and online students to conduct themselves honestly and responsibly and to respect the rights of others. Students may not engage in behavior that disrupts the learning environment, violates the rights of others, or otherwise violates the student code of conduct, university rules, regulations, or procedures. More information about the UAF Student Code of Conduct and Student Rights and Responsibilities can be found [here](#).
- High ethical standards are expected of all students in this course. Violations of the UAF Student Code of Conduct will result in an immediate "F" grade. Additionally, violations of the Student Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action initiated by UAF.

5.) Extended Absence Policy

Extended absences are defined as missed classes or course work by students beyond what is permissible by the instructor's written course policies. Students may need to miss class and/or course work for a variety of reasons, including, but not limited to:

- bereavement
- personal illness or injury
- serious illness of a friend, family member or loved one
- military obligations



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- jury service
- other emergency or obligatory situations

For more information, go to the student handbook or the Center for Students Rights and Responsibilities.

6.) UAF Incomplete Grade Policy:

Your instructor follows the University of Alaska Fairbanks Incomplete Grade Policy:

"The letter "I" (Incomplete) is a temporary grade used to indicate that the student has satisfactorily completed (C- or better) the majority of work in a course but for personal reasons beyond the student's control, such as sickness, has not been able to complete the course during the regular semester. Negligence or indifference are not acceptable reasons for an "I" grade."

For more information, see [the UAF regulations regarding grades](#).

Student Protections Statement

UAF embraces and grows a culture of respect, diversity, inclusion, and caring. Students at this university are protected against sexual harassment and discrimination (Title IX). Faculty members are designated as responsible employees which means they are required to report sexual misconduct. Graduate teaching assistants do not share the same reporting obligations. For more information on your rights as a student and the resources available to you to resolve problems, please go to the following site: <https://catalog.uaf.edu/academics-regulations/students-rights-responsibilities/>.

Disabilities Services Statement

I will work with the Office of Disability Services to provide reasonable accommodation to students with disabilities. The Office of Disability Services (Eielson Building room 104, 907-474-5655) implements the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), and ensures that UAF students have equal access to the campus and course materials.

ASUAF Advocacy Statement

The Associated Students of the University of Alaska Fairbanks, the student government of UAF, offers advocacy services to students who feel they are facing issues with staff, faculty, and/or other students specifically if these issues are hindering the ability of the student to succeed in their academics or go about their lives at the university. Students who wish to utilize these services can contact the Student Advocacy Director by visiting the ASUAF office or emailing asuaf.office@alaska.edu.

Non-Discrimination Statement

The University of Alaska is an affirmative action/equal opportunity employer and educational institution. The University of Alaska does not discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, national origin, citizenship, age, sex, physical or mental disability, status as a protected veteran, marital status, changes in marital status, pregnancy, childbirth or related medical conditions, parenthood, sexual orientation, gender identity, political affiliation or belief, genetic information, or other legally protected status. The University's commitment to nondiscrimination, including against sex discrimination, applies to students, employees, and applicants for admission and employment. Contact information, applicable laws, and complaint procedures are included on UA's statement of nondiscrimination available at www.alaska.edu/nondiscrimination. For more information, contact:



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UAF Office of Rights, Compliance and Accountability
1692 Tok Lane, 3rd floor, Constitution Hall, Fairbanks, AK 99775
907-474-7300
uaf-orca@alaska.edu

Student Academic Support

- **Speaking Center**
 - 907-474-5470
 - uaf-speakingcenter@alaska.edu
 - Gruening 507
- **Writing Center**
 - 907-474-5314
 - uaf-writing-center@alaska.edu
 - Gruening 801
- **UAF Math Services** (math fee paying students only)
 - uaf-traccloud@alaska.edu
 - Chapman Building 305
- **Developmental Math Lab**
 - CTC, Room 120, 604 Barnette Street
 - Gruening 406
- **The Debbie Moses Learning Center** at CTC
 - 907-455-2860
 - 604 Barnette St, Room 120
- **Elmer E. Rasmuson Library** (help with research)
 - 907-474-7481 (phone)
 - 907-341-4404 (text)
 - AskRasmusonLibrary@uaf.libanswers.com
 - 1732 Tanana Loop
- **Rural Student Services**
 - uaf-rss@alaska.edu
 - [Tutoring Services](#)
 - Main floor Brooks Building
- **Student Support Services**
 - (907) 474-6844
- **eCampus Student Services**
 - 907-479-3444
 - toll free 1-800-277-8060
 - [contact staff directly](#)
- **Veterans Resources Center**
 - 907-474-2475
 - Rm 111, Eielson Building.
- **Academic Advising Resource List**



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Other Student Resources:

- **[Disability Services](#)**
 - 907-474-5655
 - uaf-disability-services@alaska.edu
 - Eielson Building, room 104
- **[Student Health & Counseling](#)** [6 free counseling sessions]
 - 907-474-7043
 - [Appointments](#)
 - Whitaker 203
- **[Office of Rights, Compliance and Accountability](#)**
 - 907-474-7300
 - uaf-orca@alaska.edu
 - Constitution Hall, 3rd Floor
- **[ASUAF Student Government](#)**
 - 907-474-7355
 - asuaf.office@alaska.edu
 - Wood Center 119

Title IX

University of Alaska Board of Regents have clearly stated in BOR Policy that discrimination, harassment and violence will not be tolerated on any campus of the University of Alaska. If you believe you are experiencing discrimination or any form of harassment including sexual harassment/misconduct/assault, you are encouraged to report that behavior. If you report to a faculty member or any university employee, they must notify the UAF Title IX Coordinator about the basic facts of the incident.

Your choices for reporting include:

1. You may access confidential counseling by contacting the UAF Health & Counseling Center at 907-474-7043;
2. You may access support and file a Title IX report by contacting the UAF Title IX Coordinator at 907-474-6600;
3. You may file a criminal complaint by contacting the University Police Department at 907-474-7721. For more information please visit the [UAF Department of Equity and Compliance](#) webpage.

Any UAF employee or volunteer who reasonably suspects or observes minor abuse or maltreatment is required to report the incident. Reporting procedures are available on the UAF Protection of Minors. Violation of this policy by employees shall be reported as well.

Emergency Notification Plan

Students will receive emergency notifications via phone or email. Please check your uaonline account to confirm your emergency notification settings. for more information, please refer to the student handbook. In cases where you do not have access to your devices, as your instructor, I will take responsibility to relay any emergency notifications.